

ALEXANDER REED

Senior Python & API Developer | Backend Engineering | Cloud-Native Systems | Developer Platforms

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Professional Summary

Results-driven Python and API Developer with 9+ years of experience designing, building, and operating secure, scalable backend systems for fintech, cloud, e-commerce, and enterprise SaaS environments. Skilled in REST, GraphQL, event-driven architecture, microservices, cloud deployment, CI/CD, observability, and distributed system reliability. Known for writing clean production-grade code, improving API performance, mentoring engineers, and translating business goals into resilient technical solutions.

Core Backend Python, FastAPI, Django, Flask, SQLAlchemy, Pydantic, Celery, asyncio, pytest, Alembic, REST APIs, GraphQL, WebSockets, OAuth2, OpenID Connect, JWT, API gateways, rate limiting, idempotency, pagination, caching, background jobs. Cloud & DevOps AWS, Google Cloud, Azure basics, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Helm, Nginx, Linux, Bash, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, ELK, Sentry, Datadog. Data & Messaging PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Kafka, RabbitMQ, SQS, Pub/Sub, Snowflake basics, data modeling, indexing, query optimization, schema migrations.	API & Architecture Domain-driven design, microservices, monolith decomposition, service contracts, OpenAPI/Swagger, versioning strategies, API documentation, SDK design, webhook systems, distributed tracing, resilience patterns, fault tolerance. Security & Quality Secure coding, OWASP API Security, secrets management, RBAC/ABAC, encryption in transit and at rest, dependency scanning, unit/integration/contract testing, load testing, code review standards. Tools Git, Jira, Confluence, Postman, Insomnia, VS Code, PyCharm, Linux CLI, Make, Poetry, pip-tools, pre-commit, Black, Ruff, mypy.
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Professional Experience

Senior Backend Engineer - Python/API Platform

Google Cloud, Amsterdam, Netherlands | Mar 2023 - Present

- Designed and maintained internal API platform services used by product teams to standardize authentication, request validation, logging, tracing, and service-to-service communication.
- Built high-throughput FastAPI services on Kubernetes with OpenTelemetry instrumentation, reducing average incident diagnosis time by 38%.
- Improved API gateway routing and caching strategy, lowering p95 latency from 420 ms to 190 ms for frequently used developer workflows.

Python Backend Developer - Payments & Risk APIs

Amazon, Berlin, Germany | Jan 2020 - Feb 2023

- Developed Python microservices for payment risk scoring, fraud signals, customer verification, and internal operations workflows.
- Created asynchronous data pipelines with Kafka and Redis that processed millions of risk events daily with strong monitoring and retry controls.
- Reduced deployment failures by introducing contract tests, database migration checks, and CI quality gates across multiple services.

Software Engineer - API Integrations

Spotify, Stockholm, Sweden | Jun 2017 - Dec 2019

- Built REST and GraphQL endpoints for partner integrations, analytics dashboards, content operations, and internal workflow automation.
- Migrated legacy Flask services to FastAPI/Django-based architecture, improving maintainability and reducing duplicated business logic.
- Implemented webhook delivery service with retries, signature verification, event deduplication, and customer-facing documentation.

Junior Python Developer

Adyen, Amsterdam, Netherlands | Sep 2015 - May 2017

- Supported backend services for merchant reporting, API integrations, and operational tooling in a high-availability fintech environment.
- Wrote automated tests, improved SQL queries, built internal dashboards, and documented API integration examples for merchants.
- Gained hands-on experience with payment workflows, reconciliation, security practices, and production incident response.

Selected Projects

Enterprise API Gateway Modernization

Architected a reusable API gateway layer with authentication, throttling, structured logging, tracing, error normalization, request validation, and OpenAPI publication. Improved consistency across 40+ backend services.

Real-Time Event Processing Platform

Built Python consumers and producers using Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Kubernetes. Implemented retry queues, dead-letter handling, idempotent processing, and dashboards for operational visibility.

Developer Self-Service Portal

Created backend APIs for service registration, API key lifecycle, documentation publishing, team ownership, and deployment metadata. Reduced manual platform support requests by 45%.

Secure Webhook Delivery System

Designed customer webhook delivery with HMAC signatures, exponential backoff, delivery logs, replay capability, and tenant-level configuration.

Education

M.Sc. Computer Science - Distributed Systems and Cloud Computing

Delft University of Technology, Netherlands | 2013 - 2015

Thesis: Performance and reliability patterns for distributed API services under variable load.

B.Sc. Software Engineering

University of Amsterdam, Netherlands | 2009 - 2013

Certifications & Training

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)
- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Developer
- HashiCorp Terraform Associate
- Secure API Development and OWASP API Security Training

Hard Skills

Backend architecture, microservice design, API lifecycle management, database design, performance optimization, cloud infrastructure, container orchestration, CI/CD automation, monitoring, logging, tracing, test automation, secure software development, technical documentation, production incident response.

Soft Skills

Clear communication, technical leadership, mentoring, ownership mindset, problem solving, stakeholder management, product thinking, adaptability, remote collaboration, documentation discipline, calm incident handling, constructive code review, cross-functional teamwork.

Language Skills

English	Fluent / professional working proficiency
Dutch	Advanced professional proficiency
German	Intermediate working proficiency
French	Basic conversational proficiency

Knowledge Areas

API product strategy, distributed systems, scalability trade-offs, cloud cost awareness, data privacy, GDPR-aware engineering, software development life cycle, agile delivery, service ownership, SLOs/SLIs, incident postmortems, technical roadmap planning, developer experience, maintainable codebases, and long-term platform reliability.

API Development Expertise

- Designs API contracts with OpenAPI/Swagger, clear error models, backwards-compatible versioning, pagination, filtering, webhooks, and SDK-friendly schemas.
- Builds secure authentication and authorization flows using OAuth2, OpenID Connect, JWT, API keys, scoped access, audit logs, and tenant-aware permissions.
- Optimizes API performance through caching, database indexing, asynchronous workers, queue-based processing, load testing, and p95/p99 latency monitoring.

Cloud & Delivery Expertise

- Deploys containerized Python services with Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, CI/CD pipelines, blue-green deployment, rollback plans, and environment-specific configuration.
- Operates production systems with dashboards, SLOs, alerts, structured logs, distributed traces, incident response, postmortems, and continuous reliability improvements.

Professional Highlights

- Designed production APIs serving high-volume internal and external clients across fintech, media, cloud, and e-commerce domains.
- Strong record of improving latency, reliability, deployment quality, and developer productivity.
- Comfortable working in international teams, remote/hybrid environments, and fast-moving engineering organizations.

Additional Information

Open to senior backend, API platform, developer experience, cloud backend, and technical lead roles. References and detailed project portfolio available upon request.